

Deal 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 4
♥ A Q 9
♦ T 9 8 6 2
♣ A 9 8 5

11
10 7
12

♠ K 9 7 3
♥ 8 4 2
♦ A K 5
♣ J 7 6



♠ A Q 8 6 2
♥ J 5 3
♦ 7 4
♣ K Q 2

♠ J T 5
♥ K T 7 6
♦ Q J 3
♣ T 4 3

West	North	East	South
	Pass	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	3 ♠		
All Pass			
3 ♠ by South			

Baker Bidpractice/Set3 17

NORTH has just 11 points, not enough to open the bidding.

But when SOUTH opens 1 ♠ NORTH should show her "almost opening strength"

by jumping to 3 ♠.

SOUTH has just 13 points, and knowing NORTH has less than 13 he passes.

Deal 2

South Deals
None Vul

♠ 5
♥ J T 9
♦ J T 9 7 4
♣ A J 7 3

9
7 10
14

♠ 7 3
♥ Q 8 6 4 2
♦ A 8 6
♣ K 9 5



♠ T 8 2
♥ A K 7 5 3
♦ K Q 5
♣ Q 6

♠ A K Q J 9 6 4
♥ -
♦ 3 2
♣ T 8 4 2

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After SOUTH opens with 1



, NORTH has a small "dilemma".

With 11 points she really is only strong enough
to make a jump raise to 3



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West North East South

1 ♥

Pass 4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by South

But, with five trumps the hand deserves more.
So she just bids 4



instead.

Usually, no matter what your strength, when you have five cards in the Major suit that your
partner opens

with you should just jump right to game.

Deal 3

North Deals
None Vul

♠ A 9 6 4
♥ Q T 8 3
♦ T 4 2
♣ 7 5

19
6 8
7

♠ Q J 7 5
♥ A
♦ A K Q 3
♣ K T 6 2



♠ K T 8 3
♥ J 7 2
♦ 9 8 6
♣ Q J 3

♠ 2
♥ K 9 6 5 4
♦ J 7 5
♣ A 9 8 4

West	North	East	South
	1 ♦	Pass	1 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			

4 ♠ by South
she revalues her hand to 21 points, enough for game.

She bids 4 ♠.

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NORTH has 19 points, but no 5-card Major suit. With two 4-card minor suits she should start

with 1

♦

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SOUTH has a poor hand, but with 7 points he must respond. His first priority is to show a Major suit

so he responds 1 ♠.

NORTH now knows that ♠s will be trumps, so

Deal 4

South Deals
None Vul

♠ 8 5 2
♥ A T 6 3
♦ K 8 3 2
♣ 8 7

9
7 8
16

♠ T 9 6 3
♥ 7 5 4
♦ Q 7
♣ A K 6 4



♠ K Q J 7 4
♥ K Q 2
♦ A J 6
♣ 9 3

♠ A
♥ J 9 8
♦ T 9 5 4
♣ Q J T 5 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Pass	2 ♠	Pass	3 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by South			

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NOTE: There is a better way to bid this hand using special conventions.

SOUTH has 17 points, but with a 5-card Major opens 1 ♠ rather than 1NT.

NORTH isn't quite strong enough for a jump raise, so she bids 2 ♠.

SOUTH has enough extra to make a try for game, so she invites with 3 ♠.

NORTH has enough extra to accept the invitation, bids 4 ♠.